

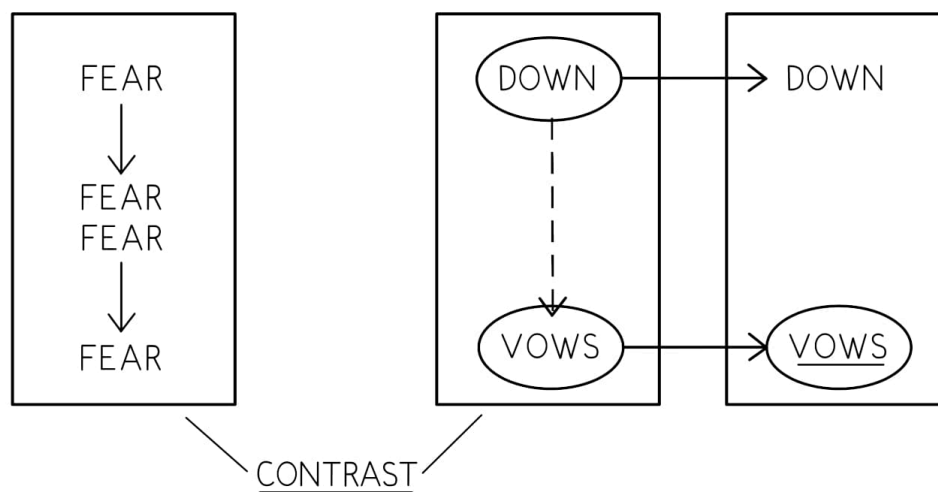
Session 17: Repeated Words and Implications for Literary Design

Key Takeaways

- Biblical narrative achieves maximal characterization through minimal details. The authors do a lot with a little, which is why everything matters.
- Symmetrical design is when repeated words link passages that are not side by side, prompting the reader to compare the passages. All four chapters of Jonah are symmetrically designed.

The Flow of Jonah

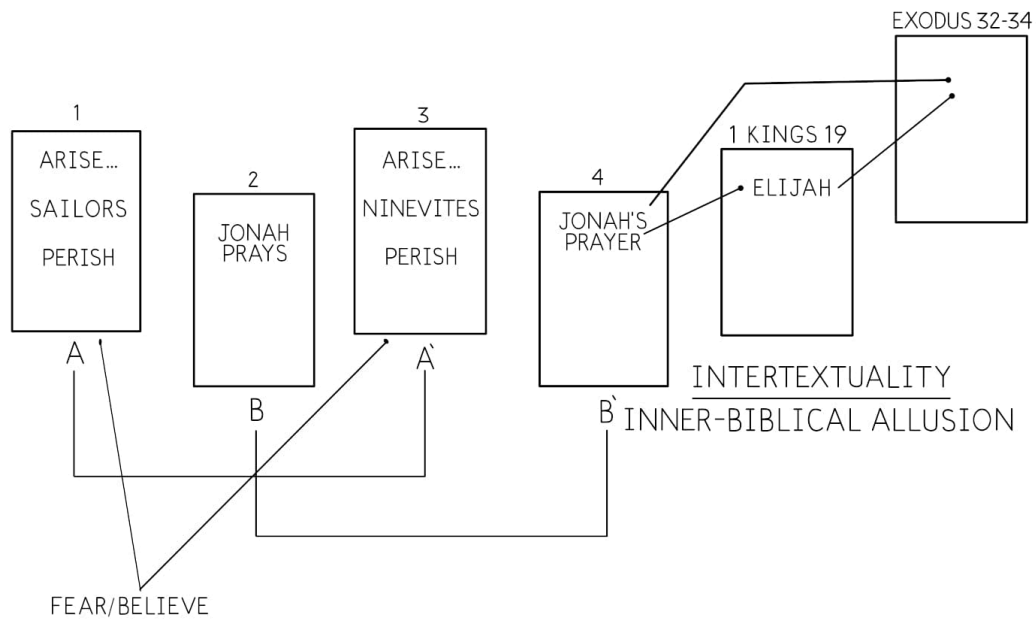
Repeated words in Jonah's literary units develop a thematic flow and lend momentum to the story arc.



Contrasts in the Design of Jonah 1. Illustration created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Jonah (2019).

Repeated words in distant literary units allow the reader to connect parts of a story that are not immediately adjacent. The biblical authors use this technique to draw together distant literary units within a scroll, or even

connect one scroll to another.



The Macro-Design of Jonah. Illustration created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Jonah (2019).

Reflection Question

What are some of the words (wordplays or themes) repeated in Jonah 1? Which might be the most significant and helpful to highlight for those in your context?